

children who themselves become loving human beings and good citizens. Success, in short, can be measured not in what we attain for ourselves, but in what we contribute to our society.

The Means, Not the End

I admit to a bias in favor of a business career—in part, for selfish reasons (business has been my own life's work) and in part out of genuine conviction. Businesses produce the goods and services that make our society work—indeed, that make so many of our lives so comfortable. Finance lubricates the machinery of capitalism. And entrepreneurship is the major force for innovation. What's more, businessmen and businesswomen at all levels of an organization have been the driving force of American capitalism that has made our incredibly wealthy economy the envy of the world. All that's to the good, but only so long as those of who have chosen business careers continue to ask ourselves whether we're chasing the fake rabbit of *success* or the real rabbit of *meaning*, defined by the contributions to our society that stem from principle, virtue, and character.

No career is the right career if it is undertaken solely to get rich, or to gain public fame, or to throw one's weight around. Nor is it the right career if it is undertaken to meet the expectations of others. And no success is the right success if it is achieved at society's expense. The proper measure? Your own expectations, and making the most of your talents.

A Special Burden

It's my conviction that those of us who do engage in business and financial careers carry a special burden, for it is in business and finance where most of the people in our society make the most money. Yet money itself can easily deceive us about what we do and why we do it. As René Descartes reminded us four full centuries